TECH EXCHANGE · ESSENTIAL DIGITAL LITERACY

Class 1 — The Fundamentals

NAME _____

Tuesday, August 25, 2026 · 11:00 AM – 3:00 PM
1721 Broadway, Oakland · MacArthur Meeting Room
NEXT CLASS Thursday, August 27 · same time, same room · bring this laptop and charger

KEEP THIS

Everything you build today is yours. Follow along in class, then take this home — the steps work the same on your own laptop.

Lab 1 · My Contact Card

12 MINUTES · HOUR 1

Every form asks for the same details. Type them once today, and paste them from now on.

1. Click the **search box** at the bottom-left of your screen.
2. Type **notepad** and press `Enter`.
3. Type your **full name**. Hold `Shift` for capital letters.
4. Press `Enter` and type your **phone number**.
5. Press `Enter` and type your **email address**.
6. Press `Enter` and type your **mailing address**.
7. Press `Ctrl`+`A` to select it all, then `Ctrl`+`C` to copy it.
8. Press `Ctrl`+`S`. Click **Documents** on the left. Type **My Info** as the name. Click **Save**.

YOU ARE DONE WHEN

You close Notepad, open it again from Documents, and your details are still there.

IF IT GOES WRONG

Typed the wrong thing? `Ctrl`+`Z` undoes it.
Cannot find the file? Type **My Info** in the search box.
Everything in capitals? Press `Caps Lock` once to turn it off.

Lab 2 · Build Your Filing Cabinet

12 MINUTES · HOUR 2

Right now everything is one pile. Give it drawers.

1. Press ⊞+E to open File Explorer. Click **Documents**.
2. Two-finger tap on empty space. Choose **New**, then **Folder**.
3. Type **My Files** and press Enter.
4. Double-tap **My Files** to go inside it.
5. Make three folders in the same way: **Personal**, **Jobs**, **Health**.
6. Click **Documents** on the left. Click **My Info.txt** once, then press Ctrl+X.
7. Go into **My Files**, then **Personal**. Press Ctrl+V.
8. Type **My Info** in the taskbar search box to prove Windows can still find it.

YOU ARE DONE WHEN

You search for My Info, open the result, and it is sitting inside Personal.

IF IT GOES WRONG

Folder still called "New folder"? Two-finger tap it, choose **Rename**.
Folders in the wrong place? Drag them into My Files.
Two copies of your file? You used Copy instead of Cut. Delete the one you do not want.

Lab 3 · Your Own Bookmarks Bar

12 MINUTES · HOUR 3

Three sites you personally need, saved so you never type them again.

1. Open your browser from the taskbar.
2. Press `Ctrl` + `Shift` + `B` to show the bookmarks bar.
3. Click the **address bar** at the top. Type the address of a site you use — your bank, the library, transit, your benefits portal. Press `Enter`.
4. Press `Ctrl` + `D`. Give it a short name. Choose **Bookmarks bar**. Click **Done**.
5. Repeat for two more sites.
6. Close the browser completely, then open it again. Your three sites should still be there.

YOU ARE DONE WHEN

You reach all three sites in one click each, without typing anything.

WHY THIS MATTERS

Typing the address yourself — or clicking your own bookmark — means you always land on the real site. Searching for a site you already know is how people end up on fake copies.

My three sites:

1. _____

2. _____

3. _____

Lab 4 · Lock It Down

12 MINUTES · HOUR 4

The two things that actually protect you.

1. Pick **four words that have nothing to do with each other**. Not your name, not your street, not your birthday.
2. Join them with hyphens and add a number: `purple-tractor-window-42`
3. Write it on the paper card you were given. **Not** in a file on the laptop.
4. Search **Windows Security** in the taskbar. Open it. Check that everything shows a green tick.
5. Open **virustotal.com**. Choose **URL**. Paste the link your instructor gives you and press `Enter`. Read the result.

YOU ARE DONE WHEN

You can say your passphrase from memory without looking, and you know where Windows Security lives.

IMPORTANT

Never save a password or passphrase in the same file as your name, address, and phone number. Paper, or a password manager. Nothing in between.

Take this home · Five habits

HABIT	WHAT IT MEANS
1. Pause before you click	Read the web address from the left. Stop at the first single slash. That name is who you are really dealing with.
2. Different passphrase for the important accounts	Email, bank, and anywhere your card is saved. Never the same one twice.
3. Two-step sign-in on your email first	Whoever controls your email can reset everything else you own.
4. Updates on. Downloads from the store or the real site only	A pop-up saying your computer is infected is the threat, not the fix.
5. Gift cards are never a real way to pay a real bill	No government office, utility, or bank has ever asked for one. Not once.

The four signs of a scam

1. **Urgency** — act now, within 24 hours, your account will be closed.
2. **A threat or a prize** — arrest, a fine, a suspension, or something you won but never entered.
3. **The address is wrong** — close to a real name, but not quite it.
4. **An unusual way to pay** — gift cards, wire transfer, cryptocurrency, an app.

> IF YOU ARE NOT SURE
>
> Do not use the link or number they gave you. Look up the real organisation yourself and contact them directly. A real organisation will not mind you calling back.

Shortcuts worth remembering

KEYS	WHAT IT DOES
`Ctrl` + `Z`	Undo — takes back your last action
`Ctrl` + `S`	Save
`Ctrl` + `C` / `Ctrl` + `V`	Copy / Paste
`Ctrl` + `X`	Cut — pick something up to move it
`⊞`	Open the Start menu
`⊞` + `E`	Open File Explorer
`⊞` + `D`	Jump back to the desktop
`Alt` + `Tab`	Switch between open programs
`Ctrl` + `D`	Bookmark the page you are on
`Esc`	Back out of almost anything

Shutting down properly

1. Save anything open — `Ctrl` + `S`.
2. Click **Start**, then the **Power** icon.
3. Choose **Shut down**.
4. Wait until the screen is completely black, then close the lid.

ALL COURSE MATERIALS ONLINE

Every slide and both handouts from Class 1 and Class 2:

techexchange-class.vercel.app

Point your phone camera at the square and tap the link that appears.
On a laptop, type the address above, then press `Ctrl` + `D` to bookmark it.

THURSDAY, AUGUST 27

Email · Google Drive, Docs and Sheets · Zoom · Google Meet.
Same time, same room. Bring this laptop and its charger.

My Device ID: _____